



URBAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
LAW, No. 41 of 1978
OF
THE NATIONAL STATE ASSEMBLY

[Certified on 6th September, 1978]

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*Urban Development Authority
Law, No. 41 of 1978*

[Certified on 14th September, 1978]

L. D.—O. 65/77.

A LAW TO PROVIDE FOR THE ESTABLISHMENT OF AN URBAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY TO PROMOTE INTEGRATED PLANNING AND DEVELOPMENT OF ECONOMIC, SOCIAL AND PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT OF CERTAIN AREAS AS MAY BE DECLARED BY THE MINISTER TO BE URBAN DEVELOPMENT AREAS AND FOR MATTERS CONNECTED THEREWITH OR INCIDENTAL THERETO.

BE it enacted by the National State Assembly of the Republic of Sri Lanka as follows:—

1. This Law may be cited as the Urban Development Authority Law. No. 41 of 1978, and shall come into operation on such date as the Minister may appoint by Order published in the *Gazette*.

Short title
and date of
operation.

PART I

ESTABLISHMENT AND CONSTITUTION OF THE URBAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

2. (1) With effect from such date as may be fixed by the Minister by Notification published in the *Gazette*, there shall be established an Authority which shall be called the Urban Development Authority of Sri Lanka, hereinafter referred to as the "Authority".

Establishment
of the
Urban
Development
Authority.

(2) The Authority shall be a body corporate with perpetual succession and a common seal and may sue and be sued in its corporate name.

(3) The head office of the Authority shall be in Colombo.

(4) The Authority may, with the prior approval of the Minister, establish and maintain branch offices

3. (1) Where the Minister is of opinion that any area is suitable for development, the Minister may by Order published in the *Gazette*, declare such area to be an Urban Development Area (hereinafter referred to as a "development area").

Declaration
of area as
development
area by
Order of
Minister
and effect
thereof.

(2) An Order under subsection (1) shall define that area by setting out the metes and bounds of such area.

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(3) The Authority shall develop every development area for the better physical and economic utilization of such area.

**Constitution
of the
Board of
Management
of the
Authority.**

4. (1) The management and administration of the affairs of the Authority shall be vested in a Board of Management (hereinafter referred to as " the Board ") which shall consist of—

- (a) a Chairman nominated by the Minister;
- (b) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subject of Local Government nominated by such Minister;
- (c) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subject of Finance nominated by such Minister;
- (d) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subject of Lands nominated by such Minister;
- (e) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subjects of Irrigation, Power and Highwayf, nominated by such Minister;
- (f) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subject of Industries nominated by such Minister;
- (g) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subject of Transport nominated by such Minister;
- (h) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subject of Ifealth nominated by such Minister;
- (i) a senior officer of the Ministry of the Minister in charge of the subject of Education nominated by such Minister;
- (j) the person. holding office for the time **being as Director, Town and Country Planning;**
- (k) the person holding office for the time **being as Chairman, National Housing Development Authority;**
- (l) **the person holding office for the time being as General Manager of the Authority, who shall be the Secretary of the Board;**

*Urban Development Authority
Law. No. 41 of 1978*

- (m) two other members, other than *state* officers. nominated by the Minister to represent the interests of local authorities ; and
- (n) two other members nominated by the Minister from among persons who appear to him to have a knowledge of, and experience in, urban development.

(2) A person shall be disqualified for nomination, or for continuing, as a member of the Board—

- (a) if he is, or becomes, a Member of the National State Assembly ; or
- (b) if he is not, or ceases to be, a citizen of Sri Lanka.

(3) The Chairman and the members nominated by the Minister under paragraphs *(a)*, *(m)* and *(n)* of subsection (1) shall subject to the provisions of subsections (4) and (7) hold office for a term of three years but shall be eligible for re-nomination.

(4) The Minister may remove from office the Chairman or any member—

- (a) if he becomes subject to any disqualification mentioned in subsection (2) ; or
- (b) if he becomes permanently incapable of performing his duties owing to physical disability or unsoundness of mind ; or
- (c) if he does any act or thing which, in the opinion of the Minister, is likely to bring the Board to disrepute :

Provided, however, that no member nominated under paragraphs *(b)* to *(1)* of subsection (1), shall be removed from office under this subsection without the concurrence of the Minister who nominated such member.

(5) In the event of the vacation of office by the Chairman or any other member of the Board, or his removal from office under the provisions of the preceding subsection, the Minister may nominate another person to hold such office during the unexpired part. of the term of office of the member whom he succeeds :

**Urban Development Authority
Line, NO. 41 of 1973**

Provided, however, that if such vacation of office or removal from office is by, or of, a member nominated under paragraphs (b) to (i) of subsection (1), no nomination shall be made under this subsection without the concurrence of the Minister who nominated such member.

(6) If the Chairman or any member of the Board is temporarily unable to discharge the duties of his office due to ill health or absence from Sri Lanka or for any other cause, the Minister may nominate some Other person to act in his place as Chairman or as member :

Provided, however, that if the member so unable to discharge the duties of his office is a member nominated under paragraphs (b) to (i) of subsection (1), no nomination shall be made under this subsection without the concurrence of the Minister who nominated such member.

(7) The Chairman or any member of the Board may at any time resign his office by letter to that effect addressed to the Minister.

(8) The Minister may, by Order published in the *Gazette*, remove any member from office without assigning the reason therefor and such removal shall not be called in question in any Court:

Provided, however, that no member nominated under paragraphs (b) to (i) of subsection (1) shall be removed under this subsection without the concurrence of the Minister who nominated such member.

(9) The Chairman or any member of the Board may be paid such remuneration out of the Fund of the Board, as may be determined by the Minister.

(10) The members nominated under paragraphs (6) to (i) of subsection (1) shall subject to the provisions of subsections (4) and (7) hold office for a term of three years.

(11) The Chairman of the Board shall if present preside **at** all meetings of the Board. in the absence of the Chairman from any such meeting, the members present shall elect one of the members to preside **at** the meeting.